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Ministry Resources Hub

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Lesson 2. Selecting Leaders

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Lesson 2. Selecting Leaders

I. INTRODUCTION: THE IMPORTANCE OF DEVELOPING LEADERS

A. The Need for Multiplication through Leadership:

1. One of the primary goals of disciple-making movements is to create a multiplying effect, where disciples become disciple-makers and leaders who develop other leaders. This multiplication is critical for the spread of the Gospel and the expansion of God's Kingdom.
2. Developing Leaders: Developing leaders is not just about teaching them skills; it's about shaping their character, equipping them for ministry, and giving them opportunities to lead others in making disciples. Jesus spent His ministry not just teaching the crowds but intentionally investing in a few who would carry on His work.

II. LEADERSHIP IN THE EXAMPLE OF JESUS

- A. **Jesus Chose Twelve to Lead:** While Jesus taught many, He selected twelve apostles to be His closest disciples and future leaders. He intentionally spent more time with these men, modeling ministry and giving them increasing responsibility (Mark 3:13-14).
- B. **Jesus Sent Them Out:** Jesus didn't keep His disciples as passive learners. He empowered them to go out, preach the Gospel, and perform miracles in His name (Luke 9:1-6). By giving them the authority and responsibility to act, He prepared them to continue His ministry.
- C. **Jesus Invested in a Few for Maximum Impact:** Jesus invested the majority of His time in a few key leaders—Peter, James, and John. This deeper investment in a smaller group ensured that these leaders would have the depth of knowledge, experience, and relationship with Him to lead others after His departure.

III. THE PROCESS OF SELECTING LEADERS

A. Praying for God's Guidance:

1. **Jesus Prayed Before Selecting Leaders:** Before choosing His twelve apostles, Jesus spent the entire night in prayer (Luke 6:12-13). Developing leaders starts

with prayer. We must ask God to guide us in identifying the right people who are called to leadership and have the potential to multiply.

2. **Pray for God's Discernment:** Seek God's wisdom to discern who has the character, humility, and faithfulness necessary to lead others. The Bible emphasizes the importance of character in leadership (1 Timothy 3:1-7). You are not just looking for skills but for people whose lives reflect the heart of Christ.

B. Looking for Faithful and Teachable Disciples:

1. **Faithfulness Over Talent:** 2 Timothy 2:2 says, "And the things you have heard me say in the presence of many witnesses entrust to reliable people who will also be qualified to teach others." Look for people who are reliable, faithful, and committed to following Jesus. They don't have to be the most talented, but they should be committed to learning and growing.
2. **Teachable Hearts:** Leaders are learners. Look for those who are teachable—people who are open to feedback, willing to admit mistakes, and eager to grow in their walk with Christ. Humility is a key characteristic of a teachable leader (Proverbs 11:2).

C. Investing in "Persons of Peace":

1. **Person of Peace:** In Luke 10:5-7, Jesus instructs His disciples to look for a "person of peace" when entering a new town. This is someone who is receptive to the Gospel, welcoming, and influential in their community. A person of peace can often be a natural leader, someone through whom the Gospel can spread to their entire relational network.

- D. **Choosing Potential Leaders:** Look for individuals who have a natural influence over others and are already respected within their social circles. These people are often the ones who can multiply disciples by using their networks to spread the Gospel.

This lesson was provided by Joshua Nations (JoshuaNations.org).